

FOR THE GREATER GOOD

According to Shriram Finance, sustainability revolves around empowering the underbanked and underserved

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PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

58 | ▶ **LAST DECEMBER**, Shriram Finance announced its decision to have a separate vertical for green financing. Christened Shriram Green Finance, it has set itself a target to achieve an AUM, or assets under management, of ₹5,000 crore in three-four years. With an existing presence in the retail NBFC space, the new venture will initially build its EV portfolio in Karnataka, Kerala, Delhi NCR and Maharashtra.

“It is important to be a part of the overall ecosystem,” says Umesh Revankar, Executive Vice Chairman, Shriram Finance. For the company, sustainability revolves around empowering the underbanked and underserved. “For around five decades, our business strategy has focused on uplifting livelihoods,” he says.

For the company, it was life as usual till high levels of interest from global investors in socially impactful and transparent financing models changed everything. “This external interest aligned with our internal commitment to articulating our social outcomes more systemically,” says Revankar. ESG moved towards becoming a strategic priority in the 2020 fiscal. He says it led to the establishment of a social finance framework to lay the foundation for mobilising ESG-labelled funding. “We raised the highest volume of social-labelled financing by any NBFC in the country with landmark transac-

